FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-18002

Issue Title : Airplane Flight Manual (AFM) Revisions for Outdated Inertial Reference System (IRS) Magnetic Variation (MagVar) Tables

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3421-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
737NG, 777, 747, 737, 757, 787, 767	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
02/16/2018	07/25/2018	07/24/2018
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Revised to status 737 MAX AFM update as complete and close FTD article.

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

Description

To maintain Boeing airplane capabilities per the type design requirements (continued airworthiness) and bring awareness to the operator to ensure their aircraft are in a state for safe flight and operations per Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 121 requirements, all Airplane Flight Manuals (AFMs) are being revised to address Inertial Reference Systems (IRS) with outdated Magnetic Variation (MagVar) tables. The AFM revisions include revisions to the limitations section and to the normal procedures section.

The AFM limitations prohibit certain flight operations in geographic areas where the accuracy of the magnetic north-referenced parameters in the inertial system's MagVar tables are no longer sufficient to satisfy the airplane type design requirements. Depending on the epoch of the IRS MagVar tables installed on an airplane (where epoch = geomagnetic Reference Point Year), the AFM revisions may impact flight operations worldwide. The AFM limitations apply to all airplanes equipped with Honeywell Air Data Inertial Reference Units (ADIRUs) which utilize synthetically derived Magnetic Heading and Magnetic Track based on an internal static Magnetic Variation Model/Table.

Refer to Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-34-231-A for a decription of the AFM revisions.

737MAX IRS MagVar tables are epoch 2015, therefore the limitations do not currently apply.

Background

Boeing began receiving reports of difficulties completing autopilot coupled approaches beginning in 2012. The primary cause was determined to be outdated MagVar tables in the airplane's IRS which exceeded the Autopilot Flight Director System's (AFDS's) ability to compensate, resulting in degraded localizer capture and tracking performance. Boeing committed to the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) that all affected model AFMs will be revised to include operational limitations due to outdated IRS MagVar tables by mid-2018.

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See Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-34-231-A for additional background information.

Status

All 737MAX model airplane's AFM updates are complete.

Interim Action

None

Final Action

All 737MAX model airplane AFM updates are complete.

Milestones

All 737MAX model airplane AFM updates are complete.

AFM Updates Completed: June 2018

Operator Action

None. Information only.

Part Information

Honeywell ADIRU, Part Number (P/N) HG2050BC04

NOTE: there is no Boeing part number

Affected Documents

Airplane Flight Manuals (AFMs)

Supplier Information

Honeywell Inc.

Commercial Flight Systems

8840 Evergreen Blvd.

Minneapolis, MN 55433

Phone: 612-957-4408

Fax: 612-957-4698 or -4195

https://myaerospace.honeywell.com/wps/portal/

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date

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Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-34-231	A	02/09/2018

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability

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